

NovaTech Employee & Security Policies

1. Employment, Conduct, and Leave

Effective January 2026 · Fictional material for classroom use

NovaTech Solutions provides 20 days of paid annual leave each calendar year. Employees request planned leave in PeopleHub at least five business days in advance when practical. Managers normally respond within two business days. Unused annual leave may carry over up to five days and must be used by March 31.

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave. For absences longer than three consecutive workdays, People Operations may request appropriate documentation. NovaTech also provides 12 weeks of paid parental leave after six months of employment and three paid volunteer days per year.

All employees must act respectfully, protect confidential information, avoid conflicts of interest, and report suspected misconduct through a manager, People Operations, or the confidential SpeakUp channel.

NovaTech Employee & Security Policies

2. Hybrid and Remote Work Policy

Effective January 2026 · Fictional material for classroom use

Roles marked hybrid normally require two anchor days per week at the employee's assigned hub. Teams publish their anchor days each quarter. Fully remote roles are allowed when the employment agreement explicitly says remote or when People Operations approves an accommodation.

Employees working remotely must be reachable during the team's four-hour core collaboration window. They must use a company-managed device, connect through the NovaSecure VPN on untrusted networks, keep screens private, and avoid confidential conversations in public spaces.

Temporary work from another domestic location is permitted for up to 20 working days per calendar year with manager approval. International remote work requires People Operations, tax, and security approval before travel; it is not automatic.

AI engineering teams also follow the stricter data and experiment controls in the NovaTech AI Engineering Guide. If two policies differ, the more protective security rule applies.

NovaTech Employee & Security Policies

3. Information Classification and Access

Effective January 2026 · Fictional material for classroom use

NovaTech information has four levels: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Public content is approved for anyone. Internal content is for NovaTech workers. Confidential content includes customer contracts, non-public roadmaps, and employee records. Restricted content includes credentials, production secrets, regulated personal data, and customer encryption keys.

Access follows least privilege and is reviewed every quarter for production systems. Managers approve business access; system owners approve technical access. Restricted access also requires security approval and multi-factor authentication. Access must be removed within four hours after an employee's departure is recorded.

Confidential and Restricted information must be encrypted in transit and at rest. Restricted information may be stored only in approved systems and must not be copied into personal email, consumer storage, or unapproved AI tools.

NovaTech Employee & Security Policies

4. Security Baseline

Effective January 2026 · Fictional material for classroom use

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, source control, cloud systems, VPN, and administrative tools. Passwords must be unique and stored in the approved password manager. Sharing accounts or authentication factors is prohibited.

Company devices use full-disk encryption, endpoint protection, automatic screen lock after ten minutes, and centrally managed security updates. Critical patches must be applied within seven days; high-severity patches within 14 days.

Employees report suspected phishing, lost devices, exposed credentials, or unusual account activity immediately using the Security button in HelpDesk or by calling the Security Response Desk. A lost device should be reported within one hour. Employees should not investigate an incident on their own.

NovaTech Employee & Security Policies

5. Customer Data and Retention

Effective January 2026 · Fictional material for classroom use

Customer data is used only for the documented service purpose and according to the customer agreement. Production customer data must not be used in development or AI evaluation unless the data owner and Security approve a documented exception.

Support attachments are retained for 90 days after ticket closure unless a contract requires a different period. Security audit logs are retained for 13 months. Project teams define retention for derived datasets and vector indexes before launch; deletion of source data must trigger deletion or rebuilding of derived indexes where applicable.

A suspected customer-data exposure is a priority-one incident. Notify the Security Response Desk immediately, preserve evidence, and do not contact the customer unless the incident commander authorizes communication.